

Santiago Correal

I write the angles, hooks and scripts behind Meta ads that sell.

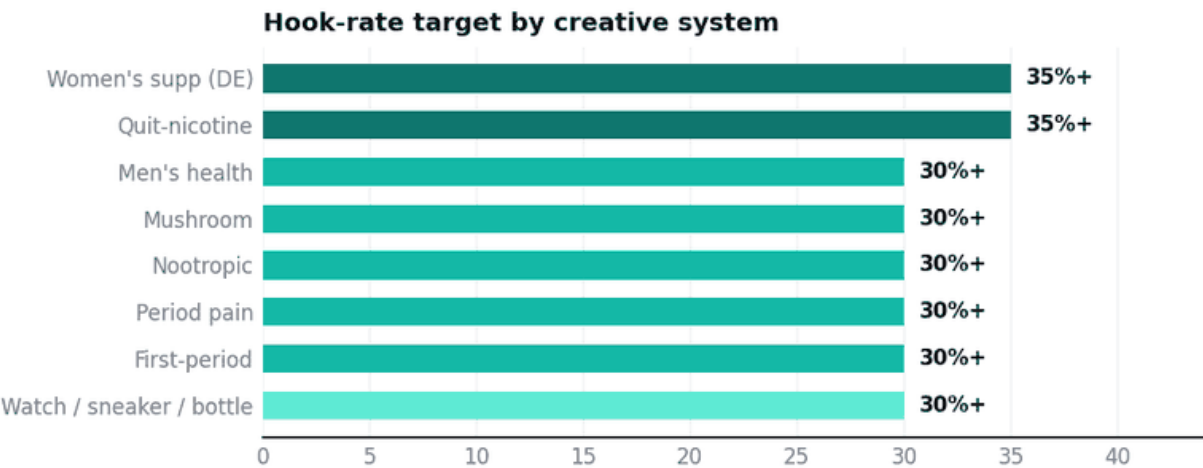
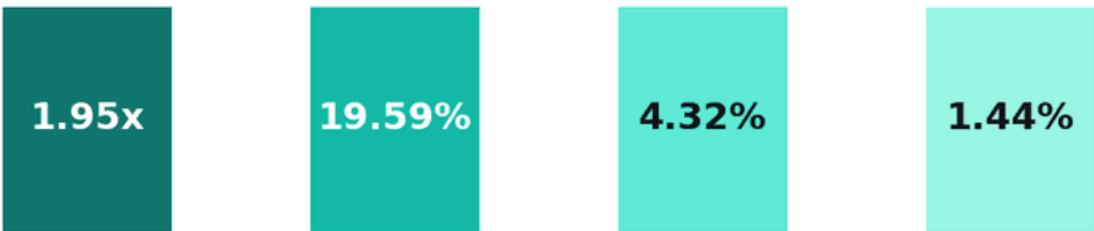
Direct-response performance creative for DTC supplement, health and wellness brands. I map awareness and sophistication stages, write the hooks before anything gets designed, and brief the editors so they can execute without a back-and-forth. I do not edit video and I do not buy media.

Native English and Spanish, fluent Italian · Top Rated on Upwork, 100% Job Success · Meta Blueprint certified

EUR 2.2M	1.9x	EUR 362K	30-40%
Net sales, women's supplement brand (DE)	ROAS on a subscription model	Meta spend managed, 53 campaigns	Hook rate the system targets

Net sales and ROAS are brand-level figures over the engagement. Hook rate, hold rate, CTR and CPC are the targets each creative system was built and tested against.

Women's supplement (DE): account averages, 53 campaigns



Ten documented brands. Seven sit in health, supplements or wellness, which is where the compliance work and the strongest attributed numbers are. Live page with every ad creative, including video: kalajar2000.github.io/case-studies

Women's Supplement Brand — Germany

FLAGSHIP

MY ROLE · CREATIVE STRATEGIST

A women's supplement brand launching in Germany in a sensitive niche, where repeated Meta ad-account suspensions limited what could run. From day one I built a compliant, UGC-driven creative system: structured testing, clear angles, and policy-safe messaging that still sold. The brand passed EUR 2.2M in net sales.

Fifty-three campaigns were run across roughly EUR 362K of Meta spend. Statics and UGC video went out in parallel against the same angle set, so a winning message could be identified separately from the format carrying it, and angles were mapped against awareness and sophistication stage before anything was designed.

EUR 2.2M	1.9x	53	30-40%	8-12%	EUR 1.80-2.20
Net sales	ROAS (subscription)	Campaigns	Hook rate	Hold rate	CPC

Why it worked: writing inside structure-and-function claim language from the first draft, rather than trying to soften a non-compliant hook afterwards. Compliant angles ship, stay live and accumulate learning. Aggressive ones get pulled, and every pull resets the account's standing with review.

Proof on the live page: the Ads Manager account view — 53 campaigns, EUR 362,191.26 spent, 1.95 average purchase ROAS, 19.59% average hook rate, 4.32% hold rate, 1.44% CTR, EUR 1.97 CPC.

Nootropic Focus Drink

MY ROLE · CREATIVE STRATEGIST

A natural nootropic focus drink in a crowded functional-beverage market. The job: make a functional drink unmissable in-feed and pull a skeptical, productivity-minded buyer. I built around a blunt thumb-stop hook, a clear product intro, and a comparison angle vs coffee and energy drinks, anchored by a strong star-rating proof point and a BuzzFeed-style founder video for warm audiences.

Because the buyer is sceptical of the category rather than the brand, the system leans on borrowed credibility and side-by-side comparison instead of claiming an outcome directly.

30%+	8-12%	1.5%+	3:2:2
Hook rate	Hold rate	CTR	Hook / body / CTA testing

The angle: the incumbent is coffee, not another nootropic. So the creative argues on calories, fat and dose, and borrows authority from where the target buyer already works.

Three videos on the live page: the borrowed-authority hook, the energy-drink comparison, and the cold-traffic product intro.

Functional Mushroom Supplement

MY ROLE · CREATIVE STRATEGIST

A functional-mushroom supplement in a crowded category where why us is everything. I led an advertorial and listicle creative system built on one differentiator, extraction quality (Why extraction is everything), with a three-minute editorial read that pre-sells the science, plus UGC for the focus product to carry everyday-use proof.

Advertorial was the right format because the argument needs room. A 15-second video cannot explain why extraction ratio changes what the customer actually absorbs; a long-form editorial can, and it gives the ad something to say that a competitor cannot copy inside a week.

30%+

Hook rate

10%+

Hold rate

1.5%+

CTR advertorial to PDP

Why it worked: in a commoditised category, the specification is the angle. Whoever explains the mechanism first owns it. Audience warmed via education before the offer.

Men's Sexual-Health Supplement

COMPLIANCE

MY ROLE · CREATIVE STRATEGIST

A men's ED and sexual-health supplement in a high-sensitivity, heavily moderated category. The strategy: a problem-aware, disarming creative system. A reverse-psychology video hook to beat ad fatigue and stigma, plus a character-led static to open the conversation without tripping policy. Messaging written around structure-and-function framing to keep the account safe.

The failure mode here is not a bad CPA. It is a dead ad account, and with it every audience signal the account had accumulated. No explicit before/after, no in-platform disease claims.

30%+

Hook rate

10%+

Hold rate

1.5%+

CTR to advertorial

Why it worked: the constraint became the creative brief. Working inside FTC and FDA claim rules forces you to sell through situation and identity rather than a promise, which is more durable copy in any category.

The video hook on the live page: "3 Reasons Why I HATE This ED Solution" — it stops the scroll and disarms the stigma without making a product claim in the first frame.

If your product touches health claims, minors, detox, or anything Meta treats as sensitive, this is the work that matters more than the ROAS number above it. Ask me about it directly.

WOMEN'S HEALTH

Drug-Free Period Pain Device

MY ROLE · CREATIVE STRATEGIST

A drug-free device for period and endometriosis pain. The audience is in real pain and tired of being dismissed, so the creative leads with empathy and proof. I built a UGC and comparison system: real users wearing the device, a direct you-don't-have-to-experience-such-pain message, and a comparison and sale angle to convert the considered, high-intent shopper.

30%+

Hook rate

10%+

Hold rate

1.5-2%

CTR

The angle: the competitor is not another device, it is ibuprofen. The ad has to beat the habit, not the category. Comparison plus offer built to lift CVR on a considered purchase.

First-Period Care Brand

MY ROLE · CREATIVE STRATEGIST

A first-period care brand making products for young girls, sold to moms. This is an emotional purchase, not a spec sheet. I led a parent-targeted system built on an empathy hook (Don't let your daughter feel unprepared like I did), product reassurance (absorbs like 4 tampons, odor-locking, right size for first-timers), and a money-back guarantee to de-risk the first order.

The structural problem is that the buyer is a parent and the user is a child, and the two need different promises inside a single ad.

30%+

Hook rate

10%+

Hold rate

1.5%+

CTR

The angle: written to the parent's fear of getting it wrong, not to the product's feature list. The guarantee is used to lift CVR and protect first-order ROAS.

HABIT CHANGE

Quit-Nicotine Brand

MY ROLE · CREATIVE STRATEGIST

A quit-nicotine brand in a category full of skepticism, where social proof is the whole game. I built a UGC and social-proof system: real-person testimonials styled as native social posts (comment plus reactions), honest I-thought-it-was-a-joke angles, and compliant results disclaimers, so the creative felt like a friend's recommendation instead of an ad.

30-40%

Hook rate

10%+

Hold rate

1.5-2%

CTR

The angle: social proof does the persuading and the brand stays out of the way. Scepticism-then-conversion is the arc that performs, and disclaimed claims keep the account compliant while scaling.

Video on the live page uses a third-person entry point: "The easy way to make your husband quit smoking." The buyer is often not the smoker.

FITNESS & ACCESSORIES

All-Steel Shaker Bottle

MY ROLE · CREATIVE STRATEGIST

A DTC brand selling the first all-steel shaker bottle. With a physical product, the win is making the differentiators obvious fast. I led a benefits-forward static system (no smell or bacteria, 36+ hour insulation, lifetime warranty, patented all-steel design) paired with a review-led angle, so the creative carried both the spec and the social proof a considered purchase needs.

25-35%

Hook rate

1.5-2%

CTR

One-time

Built for marginal ROAS

The angle: every callout answers a specific objection to paying more. The review angle was scaled once the benefits proved out, so social proof carried the spend rather than the spec sheet.

APPAREL, FOOTWEAR & WATCHES

Vegan Sneaker Brand — Germany

MY ROLE · CREATIVE STRATEGIST

A sustainable vegan sneaker brand (cactus leather) sold into the German market. The strategy was to make sustainability concrete instead of vague. I led a benefits-led creative system in German (veganes Kaktusleder, leicht und bequem, natürliche rutschfeste Sohle, Fussbett aus Bio-Baumwolle), turning each eco-claim into a tangible reason to buy for a values-driven shopper.

25-35%

Hook rate

8-12%

Hold rate

1.5%+

CTR

The angle: sustainability is a tiebreaker, not a purchase driver, so each eco-claim was converted into a benefit. Localised DE copy to protect relevance, CTR and CPC.

Automatic Watch Brand

MY ROLE · CREATIVE STRATEGIST

An automatic skeleton watch brand at an accessible price. For a considered, design-led purchase, the creative has to make the product the hero and create urgency at the right moment. I led a product-hero and seasonal-promo system (BFCM, up to 40% off storewide), pairing premium product visuals with clear offer framing to pull the deal-driven buyer.

25-35%

Hook rate

8-12%

Hold rate

1.5%+

CTR

The angle: promo windows used to compress the buying decision. In BFCM the offer is the hook, so the job of the visual is credibility, justifying the pre-discount price.

HOW I WORK

- 1 Map awareness and sophistication.** Where the market already sits decides whether the ad opens with a problem, a mechanism, or a claim. Skipping this step is the single most common reason a creative test produces unreadable results.
- 2 Write hooks per angle before anything is designed.** The angle is the unit of testing, not the asset. Design follows the message, never the reverse.
- 3 Run statics and UGC video in parallel.** Same angles, two formats. This separates the winning message from the winning format, which a single-format test cannot do.
- 4 Brief editors and creators so they execute once.** A brief that needs three rounds of clarification was not finished when it was sent. Briefs go out with the hook, the beat structure, the references and the reason.
- 5 Iterate on hook rate, hold rate, CTR and CPC.** Using a 3:2:2 hook/body/CTA structure, and killing on evidence rather than on taste.

What I don't do: I don't edit video and I don't buy media. I hand finished briefs, hooks and scripts to your editors, and the numbers back to whoever runs the account. If you need one person to do all three, I'm the wrong hire and I'd rather say so now.

BACKGROUND

Scaled SteadyEcom to \$2M a year — owning creative strategy alongside the funnel, the automations and the ads attribution, so I read the numbers that say which creative is actually working rather than only what Ads Manager reports.

Built and sold an AI marketing agency — Avalanche AI, with clients including Wholesome Good.

Led a team of 70 at NexxAI — across marketing, creative strategy and AI.

Past 5M views on short-form and UGC — for a supplement brand, converted to sales rather than left as reach.

Grew a wellness brand from 800 to 13K followers in six months — fully organic.

Compliance — I write inside structure-and-function claims plus FTC and FDA rules. In health and wellness this is usually the difference between a campaign that compounds and an account that gets restricted.

Certifications Meta Blueprint · TikTok Academy Creative · HubSpot Content Marketing · Google Digital Marketing

Education ESADE, MSc Innovation & Entrepreneurship

Want to see whether the angles hold up on your product?

Send me your product page and your current best-performing ad. I'll come back with three angles I'd test against it and the reasoning behind each, written out. No call required. If it's useful we can talk. If it isn't, you've lost nothing.

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Brand names are withheld where the engagement was under NDA and can be confirmed on a call.